

PUBLIC SECTOR UNDERTAKINGS

It is no mean feat that a nation once drained of its resources contributed in a significant way to the rebuilding efforts of other nations with shared experiences. In this, the railways and its Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) played a significant role. In a way, the PSUs have helped railways move with the times.

By the last quarter of the 20th century, the railways had recuperated from the strains of Partition and made several advances, its system firmly established and supported by the pillars of indigenous technology and expertise. The refashioning of the railway system is perhaps a paradigm of how a developing nation, once a colony and severely marred in its freedom movement, successfully rebuilt its infrastructure and bounced back on its feet. Impressed by India's transition to Independence, many other developing nations looked at it for a helping hand. Thus, in the 1960s, India provided technological assistance and expertise to countries such as Ghana, Nigeria, Zambia, Iraq, and the Philippines. The collaborations were perceived to be advantageous. The countries shared similar histories and thus similar requirements, such as rebuilding programmes at a low cost.